Business Plan

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Business Opportunity

Atlas Games (Pty) Ltd (working name) grew from a clear purpose: teach life-saving cancer knowledge through play. The founding team's prototype, *Cancer Crusher*, showed that teens engage faster when key facts and myth-busting are embedded in a fun game loop and progress depends on answering questions correctly. Partnering with Love Your Nuts (LYN),a Section 18A South African NPO focused on testicular cancer awareness,grounds the studio's first products in a real, urgent need (Love Your Nuts, n.d.; Love Your Nuts, n.d.-b). Testicular cancer is most common in adolescents and young men (±15–45), and early detection matters (CANSA, 2023; De Meyts, 2020).

Why games, why now? Recent systematic reviews (2018–2023) report consistent knowledge gains and intent-to-act improvements from serious games used in health education, especially on web and mobile (Arif, García and Khan, 2024). This makes game-based learning (GBL) a strong fit for NPO campaigns that must demonstrate evidence of impact to donors.

Reaching learners at scale is feasible. South Africa's learners increasingly access mobile internet; across Sub-Saharan Africa, growth in connectivity is strong, while device affordability remains the main barrier now targeted by global coalitions (GSMA, 2023; Reuters, 2024). Designing for low-spec Android and WebGL allows broad reach without specialist hardware.

Curriculum alignment is built-in. The Department of Basic Education's Life Orientation (Grades 7–12) requires health knowledge, decision-making and responsible behaviours,exactly the outcomes our titles target via pre/post checks, pledge mechanics (e.g., monthly self-checks) and teacher notes (DBE, 2015a; DBE, 2015b).

Gap and positioning. Many campaigns still rely on assemblies and pamphlets; few SA studios specialise in culturally localised, instrumented health games that schools can run on common devices with dashboards for funders.Atlas Games (Pty) Ltd positions itself as impact-first and measurement-led: short, reskinnable minigames (myth-busting quiz, screening quest, risk-factor runner), multi-language, and analytics-ready,first for LYN, then for partners like CANSA and CSR programmes (CANSA, n.d.).

Who we serve.

- Primary buyers: health NPOs (e.g., LYN, CANSA) and corporate CSR teams funding school programmes.

- End users: learners (upper primary to FET) and teachers/facilitators in Life Orientation.

- Channels: NPO school visits, district partnerships, CSR-funded campaigns, and open web/mobile distribution beyond the classroom.

Business model and type

Company type: Private company ((Pty) Ltd) registered in South Africa, delivering B2B solutions to NPOs, NGOs, and corporate CSR programmes, with a B2B2C reach into schools and learners.
Why (Pty) Ltd: credibility for sponsors and investors, clean IP ownership, ESOP-friendly, and straightforward contracting.
Impact channel: work with/through an NPC (e.g., Love Your Nuts or a fiscal-sponsor NPC) to receive grants/donations; the NPC issues SOWs to the (Pty) Ltd for implementation.
This dual-channel model unlocks both donations/grants and service/licence revenue while keeping governance auditor-ready.

Hybrid revenue model (how we make money)

1. Impact Services (milestone SOWs)
    - Bespoke or semi-custom serious games for NPO/CSR campaigns.
    - Payment terms: 30/40/30 (kickoff/mid/acceptance).
    - Why: funds operations and creates case studies quickly.
2. Licensing (ARR) of a reskinnable minigame library
    - Annual licence per NPO/region; language and branding swaps; teacher dashboards; analytics.
    - Gross margin: high; scales across multiple partners and geographies.
3. Sponsorship integrations
    - Corporate CSR co-funds builds; attribution on splash screens, in reports, and at events.
4. Support and Analytics SLAs
    - Uptime, updates, monthly dashboards, termly Impact Briefs.
5. Workshops/Training
    - Teacher onboarding; facilitator toolkits for Life Orientation sessions.

Regulatory/ethical posture: privacy-by-design analytics (no PII from minors), age-appropriate content, accessibility standards (contrast, captions, dyslexia-friendly fonts), and IRB-lite practices when collecting classroom feedback through NPO/school partners.

Shareholders | Ownership | Role

Shareholder	Ownership	Role
Matthew Derek Rall (Executive Producer / CEO)	30%	Vision, sales, partnerships, governance, impact reporting
Co-founder #2 (Technical Director / Unity Lead)	20%	Game architecture, CI/CD, performance on low-spec Android/WebGL
Co-founder #3 (Art and UX Director)	20%	Visual direction, UI/UX for accessibility, localisation
Impact/CSR Investor (anchor partner)	25%	Capital for seed and early growth; opens CSR sponsor pipeline
Industry Advisor (Education/Health)	5%	Pedagogy alignment, assessment design, school integrations

Directors | Expertise | Responsibility

Director	Expertise	Responsibility
Managing Director / Executive Producer	Venture leadership, stakeholder mgmt., NPO/CSR partnerships	Strategy, budgets, SOWs, contracts, donor/CSR reporting
Finance and Partnerships Director	Finance, grants/CSR, pricing, compliance	Forecasting and cash flow, billing (30/40/30), licence tiers, audit readiness
Operations and Delivery Director	Game production, QA, localisation	Roadmaps, sprint delivery, device/performance gates, SLA response

Technology Director	Unity, analytics, DevOps	Engine choices, build pipeline, telemetry schema, security/privacy
Education and Impact Director (advisory/part-time)	Curriculum and assessment	Learning outcomes, pre/post tests, teacher pack alignment

SWOT analysis

Strengths

- Impact-first + measurement-led: pre/post knowledge checks, pledge mechanics, dashboards for donors.
- Local relevance: built for SA schools (low-spec Android/WebGL, multi-language, cultural context).
- Reusable IP: reskinnable minigame library lowers cost for new campaigns, lifts margins.

Weaknesses

- Early brand: limited studio track record beyond prototype; needs strong first case studies.
- Cash timing: NPO/CSR approvals can be slow; milestone slippage stresses cash.
- Small core team: reliance on contractors for peaks (audio/localisation/QA).

Opportunities

- CSR and NGO demand for demonstrable impact; multi-year programme potential.
- Curriculum fit with Life Orientation; potential district/provincial rollouts.
- International expansion: partnerships with health NGOs across Africa and globally.

Threats

- Funding cycles and budget cuts at NPOs/CSR.
- Imitation by generalist studios without instrumentation rigor.
- Device constraints in low-resource schools; connectivity variability.

Revenue streams

Atlas Games (Pty) Ltd will generate income through a hybrid model designed for sustainability and scale across South Africa (and later internationally) while serving NPOs, NGOs, and corporate CSR programmes.

Because the model is hybrid, we blend multiple approaches rather than relying on a single source. The mix below shows how the streams interlock to fund delivery now while compounding reusable IP over time.

How the model blends together

1. Impact Services (SOW projects)
    a. Funds production today; creates case studies and reusable assets.
2. Library Licensing (ARR)
    a. Turns those assets into annual subscriptions for multiple partners.
3. Sponsorship Integrations
    a. CSR money co-funds, builds and reduces NPO cost barriers.
4. Support and Analytics SLAs (ARR)
    a. Keeps titles current, reports impact to donors, and drives renewals.
5. Workshops and Training
    a. Ensures adoption in classrooms and improves completion/impact rates.
6. Grants via NPC Partners (Non-dilutive)
    a. Underwrites pilots; studio contracted for delivery through an NPC.

The six revenue streams (with examples)

1. Impact Services (milestone SOWs)

- What: Bespoke or semi-custom serious games for health awareness campaigns (e.g., testicular cancer with Love Your Nuts; multi-cancer myth-busting packs).
- Who pays: NPOs, NGOs, corporate CSR, health agencies.
- How billed: 30/40/30 milestones (kickoff/mid/acceptance).
- Why it matters: Predictable cash for ops; creates the assets later licenced to others.
- Example: "*Cancer Crusher*: Classroom Edition" for one province with EN/AF/ISIX language pack.

2. Library Licensing (annual recurring revenue)

- What: Access to a reskinnable minigame library (myth-busting quiz, screening quest, risk-factor runner) + teacher dashboard + language packs.
- Who pays: Multiple NPOs/CSR campaigns across regions; schools/districts via partners.
- How billed: Annual licence per NPO/region, with optional multi-year discount.
- Why it matters: High-margin, scalable revenue; improves Rev/FTE as the library grows.

- Example: CANSA licences the library for 12 months across three districts with branding.

3. Sponsorship Integrations (co-funding)
   - What: Corporate sponsors fund development and activation; receive attribution (splash screen, reports, events).
   - Who pays: Banks, insurers, telcos, retailers (CSR/CSI budgets).
   - How billed: Tranches aligned to milestones or campaign dates.
   - Why it matters: Unlocks bigger budgets, reduces NPO cash burden, speeds up timelines.
   - Example: Telco sponsor funds language expansion and device giveaways for top-performing schools.
4. Support and Analytics SLAs (annual recurring revenue)
   - What: Uptime, OS/device updates, bug fixes, monthly dashboards, termly Impact Briefs.
   - Who pays: Any client using a SOW build or licence.
   - How billed: Annual or quarterly; tiered SLAs (basic/standard/enterprise).
   - Why it matters: Smooths cash flow and ties revenue to measured outcomes (renewals).
5. Workshops and Training (enablement services)
   - What: Teacher onboarding, facilitator toolkits, activation days, impact interpretation sessions.
   - Who pays: NPOs/CSR; sometimes districts via partner NPCs.
   - How billed: Per session or package; travel included as needed.
   - Why it matters: Drives classroom adoption and higher completion/knowledge lift.
6. Grants via NPC Partners (non-dilutive project funding)
   - What: Foundations and international NGOs fund pilot programmes; the NPC receives the grant and contracts the studio.
   - Who pays: Foundations, multilaterals, public health donors, corporate foundations.
   - How billed: Contracted SOWs to studio; audit-ready reporting via NPC.
   - Why it matters: Seeds new regions/cancer types without diluting ownership.

Resource Requirements

Resource requirements for Atlas Games (Pty) Ltd combine financial, human, physical, technological, content, and partner resources to deliver classroom-ready, instrumented cancer-awareness games. Figure 8 below details the core resources, estimated costs (Year-1, ZAR), and the strategic plan to acquire and deploy them.

Atlas Games (Pty) Ltd Resource Requirements

Description	Estimated Cost (ZAR)	Strategic Plan	Resource Type / Justification
Seed working capital	1,500,000 (once-off, M1)	Close an anchor impact/CSR investor tranche to fund setup and provide ≥1 month cash buffer while SOWs and licences ramp.	Financial: establishes runway and de-risks delivery.
Core team (3 FTE)	1,080,000 / year (R90,000/m)	Executive Producer (sales/PM), Unity Engineer (low-spec perf + CI), Art and UX (accessibility/localisation). Phased hiring gates tied to signed SOWs/ARR.	Human: essential capacity to produce, ship, report impact.
Contractors / QA / Localisation (COGS)	180,000 / year	Burst capacity for content, audio, device QA, and language packs (EN/AF/ISIX). Scheduled in milestone months.	Human (flex): variable delivery load without fixed headcount.
Devices and test lab	40,000 (once-off)	Purchase low-end Android reference devices + mid-range units and a lab PC for WebGL testing; create a performance/device matrix.	Physical: proves reliability on common school devices.
Software and cloud tools	96,000 / year (±R8,000/m)	Unity LTS add-ons, source control/CI, crash and analytics,	Technological: build pipeline, telemetry, and uptime.

		storage, issue tracking. Consolidate vendor discounts; annual billing where possible.	
Insurance (business and equipment)	18,000 / year (±R1,500/m)	Basic cover for devices/equipment and general liability for school activations.	Operational risk: protects assets and engagements.
Accounting and compliance	36,000 / year (±R3,000/m)	Monthly bookkeeping, annual financials, tax/VAT support; audit-ready milestone and grant reporting.	Professional services: credibility for donors/sponsors.
Professional fees (legal)	24,000 / year (±R2,000/m)	SOW templates, IP/licensing clauses, privacy policy for minors (no PII), NPC contracting.	Governance: clean IP + ethical data posture.
Marketing and communications	60,000 / year (±R5,000/m)	Gameplay reel, one-pager, case studies, landing pages; supports licence and sponsor conversions.	Growth enablement: drives pipeline and renewals.
Travel and activations	24,000 / year (±R2,000/m)	School pilots, teacher workshops, sponsor demos; bundled where possible with partner visits.	Programme delivery: ensures adoption and feedback.
Connectivity and office ops	19,200 / year (R1,600/m)	Internet and remote-first office supplies; lightweight space for occasional in-person sprints.	Operational: practical running costs.

Education and impact advisory (part-time)	0–60,000 / year (as needed)	Curriculum alignment, pre/post assessments, ethics guidance; engaged per pilot scope.	Content/Method: ensures outcomes match Life Orientation.
Contingency	5% of revenue-tied spend	Holdback for device replacements, unexpected localisation/QA, or scope clarifications via change orders.	Risk management: cushions minor shocks without re-scoping.

Year-1 cost summary (planned): Payroll R1,080,000 · COGS R180,000 · Fixed OPEX (tools/insurance/accounting/ops) R600,000 · Variable OPEX (marketing/travel) R60,000 · Devices R40,000 (included in setup) → Total operating outflows: R1,920,000. Seed capital R1,500,000 funds setup and buffer while Revenue R1,200,000 (3 SOWs + 5 licences) ramps, closing the year cash-positive as per the 12-month cash-flow plan.

12 month cash flow and resource plan

Growth strategy and risk analysis

Growth strategy

Year One: Pilot, case study, and ARR foundation

- Pilot and ship: Deliver *Cancer Crusher: Classroom Edition* with Love Your Nuts (LYN) in one province; instrument pre/post knowledge and pledge rates.
- Library v1: Build a reskinnable minigame library (myth-busting quiz, screening quest, risk-factor runner) with EN/AF/ISIX support.
- ARR start: Close 5 licences (mix of NPOs/CSR campaigns); introduce SLA tiers (updates + dashboards).
- Evidence pack: Publish Impact Brief #1 (teacher quotes, completion rates, knowledge lift).
- Sponsorships: Secure at least one CSR co-funding partner to expand content/languages.

Year Three: Multi-region rollout and dashboards

- Scale distribution: Expand to 3–5 provinces via NPO and district partners; run termly activations.
- Teacher dashboard v2: Class/grade analytics, printable reports for school leadership and donors.
- New content tracks: Add girls' health and caregiver content in collaboration with partner NGOs; modular expansion to additional cancer types.
- Commercial target: Grow ARR (licences + SLAs) as the primary revenue engine; services focus on strategic, higher-ticket builds.

Year Four: Digital reach and partnerships

- National awareness push: Coordinated digital campaigns with sponsors; in-game CTAs linking to trusted resources.
- Platform upgrades: Offline-first packs and lighter builds for low-spec devices; improve WebGL performance for labs.
- Channel partners: Formalise channel/reseller agreements with education NGOs and health agencies for regional sales.

Year Six: International collaboration

- Cross-border pilots: Partner with pan-African NGOs and global foundations; adapt library for multi-country use (languages, cultural cues).

- Evidence at scale: Comparative impact studies across regions; prepare for multi-year consortia funding.
- Selective flagship titles: Larger, multi-stakeholder builds that advance evidence and fund RandD.

Risk analysis

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Early warning signals	Mitigation / Response
Funding/approvals slip (NPO/CSR cycles delay cash)	Medium	High	PO not issued within 45 days; milestone dates move	Maintain 3× pipeline; split SOWs into smaller starts; offer upfront licence discount; keep 1+ month cash buffer from seed
Scope creep on SOWs	High	Medium	Backlog ballooning; burn > plan	Fixed SOW + change-order policy; discovery sprint sign-off; time-boxed reviews; milestone acceptance criteria
Low classroom uptake (teacher time, device constraints)	Medium	Medium	Completion <60%; teacher NPS drops	35-minute lesson plan; teacher training/workshops; offline packs; device matrix testing; simplify onboarding
Device/performance issues on low-spec Android/WebG	Medium	Medium	Crash/perf tickets; low FPS on reference	Low-spec performance gates; asset budgets; crash

L			devices	analytics; device lab; staged rollouts
Impact proof questioned (insufficient evidence)	Low–Med	High	Donor requests extra validation; renewals stall	Pre/post measures; anonymised dashboards; termly Impact Briefs; external educator review; publish methodology
Key-person risk (small core team)	Medium	High	Delays around holidays/illness; review bottlenecks	SOPs; paired ownership; CI/CD; vetted contractor bench; cross-training founders
Data privacy and consent (youth users)	Low	High	Policy queries from schools/NGOs	No PII from minors; institutional consent; privacy policy; minimal analytics; data-retention limits
Reputation risk (content sensitivity)	Low	Medium	Complaints about tone or age-appropriate ness	Educator co-design; content reviews; age-gating; clear disclaimers and escalation process
Competitive imitation	Medium	Medium	Similar offerings without measurement	Differentiator = instrumentation + curriculum fit; faster iteration; strong case

				studies; partner lock-in via dashboards

Contingency triggers (pre-committed):

- If revenue lags >20% for two consecutive months → pause non-critical contractor spend, accelerate licence campaign (upfront offer), and defer nice-to-have features.
- No new FTE until two SOWs signed or ARR ≥ R80k/month.
- If a province rollout stalls → reallocate inventory to pilot districts with confirmed teacher champions and sponsor visibility.

KPIs to steer growth:

- Commercial: ARR, SOW win rate, days sales outstanding (DSO), gross margin by stream.
- Product/ops: crash-free sessions/1k, median FPS on low-spec device, milestone on-time rate.
- Impact: knowledge lift (pre/post), completion rate, pledge rate, click-throughs to screening info, teacher NPS.

Mitigation strategy

Mitigations are matched to the studio's staged growth plan so that each phase has pre-committed actions, clear owners, and early-warning signals. Ongoing risks (utilisation dips, staff turnover, device fragmentation, funding cycles) are reviewed quarterly with KPIs for ARR, DSO, gross margin, crash-free sessions/1k, completion/knowledge-lift, and teacher NPS.

Phase-linked mitigations

Year One: Pilot, Case Study, ARR Foundation

- Cash and runway: Seed tranche ring-fences ≥1 month payroll; milestone billing (30/40/30); offer 10% discount for upfront licence payment.
- Scope and delivery: Discovery sprint + fixed SOW + change-order policy; weekly check-ins; definition of done per milestone.
- Adoption risk: Co-design with 3–5 teachers; 35-minute lesson plan; activation workshops; offline classroom packs.
- Device/performance: Low-spec performance gates; device matrix; staged rollouts; crash telemetry with 72-hour fix SLAs.

- Data/privacy: No PII from minors; institutional consent via schools/NPO; 12-month raw-event retention; public privacy policy.
- Owner(s): Exec Producer (cash/scoping), Tech Director (perf/telemetry), Education Advisor (pedagogy/consent).

Year Three: Multi-Region Rollout and Dashboards

- Capacity and quality: Contractor bench for QA/localisation; fail-safe feature flags; “golden path” smoke tests per build.
- Renewals risk: Termly Impact Briefs; renewal playbook at T-90 days; value reviews with sponsors/donors.
- Content sensitivity: Educator review panel; age-gated content; escalation checklist for complaints.
- Owner(s): Ops and Delivery Director (capacity/QA), Finance and Partnerships (renewals), Education Advisor (content).

Year Four: Digital Reach and Channel Partnerships

- Brand/reputation: Pre-moderated social channels; response templates; quarterly comms calendar with sponsors.
- Security and fraud: Hardened analytics endpoints; least-privilege access; vendor security reviews; incident runbook.
- Channel risk: Performance-based partner contracts; enablement kits (demo APK/WebGL, one-pager, case studies).
- Owner(s): Technology Director (security), Marketing/Partnerships (brand/channels).

Year Six: International Collaboration

- Compliance and localisation: Country checklists (data, IP, child protection); local partner MoUs; translation QA with back-translation.
- FX and payment risk: Contract in hard currency; partial pre-payment; hedging guidance from bank; multi-tranche schedules.
- Delivery risk across time zones: Regional producer role; clear SLAs; shared roadmap and risk log with partners.
- Owner(s): Exec Producer (contracts/FX), Regional Producer (delivery), Legal/Finance (compliance).

Quick reference table

Phase	Key risk	Early warning	Mitigation (pre-committed)

Y1	Cash gap / delayed POs	AR > 30 days; slip in kickoff	Upfront licence discounts; 3× pipeline; freeze non-critical contractors; seed buffer ≥1 month
Y1	Scope creep	Backlog balloons; burn > plan	Fixed SOW; change orders; discovery sign-off; milestone acceptance tests
Y1	Low classroom uptake	Completion <60% in pilots	Teacher training; shorter loops; offline packs; device matrix optimisation
Y3	Renewal risk	Sponsor silent at T-90	Impact Brief + review; add language/feature bundle; multi-year discount
Y4	Security/brand	Spam reports; odd traffic	Harden endpoints; monitoring; social moderation; incident playbook
Y6	Cross-border misfit	Local pushback; slow QA	Local partner MoUs; country compliance checklist; translation QA

Review cadence and decision rules

- Monthly: Cash, DSO, ARR, utilisation, crash-free sessions/1k, completion and knowledge-lift.
- Quarterly: Risk register update; hiring gates (no net new FTE unless two SOWs signed or ARR ≥ R80k/m).
- Trigger policy: If revenue lags >20% for two consecutive months, pause non-critical contractor spend, bring forward a licence campaign (upfront option), and defer non-essential features until buffer restored.

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